UNIT 4: STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESS

PART II: OBTAINING AND RETAINING WORK

TOPIC 3: RESUME

Topic OBJECTIVE: The learner will:

- Understand the purpose and importance of an up-to-date, formatted, and typed resume, in terms of positively representing their skills

Topic OUTCOME: The learner will:

- Have a complete, typed resume for their paper and electronic Student Career Portfolios, and have an online version ("My Education and Work History") stored at **Mass CIS**

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- Students will learn the purpose of a resume and understand the type of information it contains.
- Students will understand the importance of creating a resume that is professional and complete.

Time: 10 minutes

Materials: Handouts: **"Understanding a Resume"** and **"Tips for Resume Writing"**

Read aloud from **"Understanding a Resume,"** and **"Tips for Resume Writing."** Explain that a resume is similar to a "commercial" or "ad," with you as the product it is advertising. Resumes are used to promote job candidates. Encourage the students to think about education, skills and accomplishments they can include on their resumes.

Writing/Reflection/Assessment

Objectives:
- Students will learn the basic information and expectations required for a professional job resume.
- Students will begin to create a resume.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handouts: **"Resume Worksheets," "Action Words for Resume Writers,"** and **"Sample Resumes,"** pens/pencils

Ask students to begin filling out **"Resume Worksheet,"** using **"Action Words for Resume Writers"** and **"Sample Resumes"** as tools and guides. Emphasize to students to try to use "action words" when describing their skills. Give a few examples, such as "coaching," "repairing," "maintaining." Encourage students to take their time and reassure them you'll help with the final editing. Students may require the instructor's assistance with answering questions, clarifying terms, giving suggestions and knowing where to get the information necessary for each section of the resume (references will be addressed in another lesson).

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will use **Mass CIS** to create a professional/final draft resume, which can be stored, edited, and printed out for their paper portfolio.

Time: 30 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Evaluating Your Resume,"** computers with internet connection, index cards with students' **Mass CIS** log-in information, resume quality paper

Log on to **Mass CIS (www.masscis.intocareers.org),** and have students click on the link that says **"My Education and Work History."** Then ask them to begin typing in the information from their resume worksheets into the **"Resume Builder."** The students and the Instructor can both use **"Evaluating Your Resume"** to make sure the resume is a finished product. When completed, ask students to save their information at **Mass CIS** and in their electronic portfolio. Have them print a copy for their Student Career Portfolio on resume quality paper. Explain that this type of paper is available at drug stores, grocery stores, discount stores, etc. and is viewed favorably by employers.

Hints and Tips for Working with Youth on Resumes

- It is better for a resume to be basic, correct and easy to read than complicated, hard to read and with errors.

- When you sit down with someone to work on their resume, talk about what makes a good resume before they create theirs — then they won't be surprised when you edit for mistakes.

- Don't forget to praise — always point out 1 or 2 things that you really like and are impressed about in their resume — and start out on a positive foot.

- Instead of correcting every mistake as they go along, wait until they have a first draft, and hopefully, a sense of accomplishment — then make edits as necessary.

- When making edits, make sure that you explain the "why." Give them the choice to make changes and corrections. Categorize your edits into several categories — spelling, verb tense, format etc. — then ask them which of these are most important to correct and work through talking about why each of these is important.

- Put on your "employer hat" and explain to them what you are looking for and how it felt to read through their resume — what stood out to you the most, what would you have like to have seen.

- Sometimes employers receive so many resumes that they are looking for reasons to narrow down the pool of applicants — correcting simple errors is a way to avoid this fate for your resume.

- Explain that, when composing a resume on the computer, they can easily copy a resume into a new document and make small changes with little effort.

- Remember that our job is to help youth present themselves in the best light possible — never encouraging misrepresentation — but creativity!

- When struggling with someone who does not want to put the time into a resume talk with them about:
  - the impression they are trying to make on an employer
  - if it is worth it to spend time writing a sloppy resume if it probably won't win them the job or the minimal extra time it will take them to have a good resume that gives them a better chance of getting a job

Adapted from Youth Options Unlimited, Boston, MA

Understanding a Resume

PURPOSE OF A RESUME

- Marketing tool to sell your experience and qualifications to potential employers.
- Summarize and highlight relevant accomplishments and skills that match the employer's current hiring needs.

SECTIONS OF A RESUME

Contact information: Name, Address, Phone Number, and Professional E-mail Address.

Education: In reverse chronological order (most recent first), list the institutions you attended and type of education you received along with dates attended and city and state where attended.

Experience: In reverse chronological order (most recent first), list the employers, city and state where you worked, dates of employment, position held, responsibilities on the job, accomplishments made, and skills developed or utilized. Remember to use action words.

Activities: List activities you are involved in with dates (month/year), name of program or organization you participated on.

Achievements: Any awards and recognitions received with dates, name of institution that honored you and title of honor.

References: Name, Company, Address, and Phone Number of three individuals that are not relatives and know your abilities and speak highly of you.

Adapted from Youth Options Unlimited, Boston, MA

Tips for Resume Writing

1. Limit the resume to one or two pages. It is better to have one page than one and a half. A half page looks like the person ran out of information.

2. Be consistent. If you do it for one, you should do it for all. If you give your high school's zip code, then you must give all zip codes.

3. Avoid using slang words.

4. Use simple words that say what you want to say.

5. Use action words.

6. Show accomplishments and problem solving skills, not just duties. Show that you can do the work required for the job.

7. Be honest.

8. Make it perfect. Check for spelling and other mistakes. Use a good copier or have the resume printed.

9. State information in a positive way. List strongest skills and best work experience first.

10. Do not include personal information such as date of birth, height, weight, etc.

11. Include a cover letter when sending the resume.

12. Balance your resume on the page.

13. Include volunteer work, hobbies, and awards if they show experiences or skills.

14. Use action words ending with "ed" for past jobs. Use action words ending with "ing" for present jobs.

15. Choose a high quality, 8 1/2 x 11-inch white or ivory paper. Use between 20- and 24-pound 100 percent cotton fiber paper and a good duplicating (copying) process.

    Commercial copy services usually produce good copies at low cost, and have quality paper at a per sheet price. Check the telephone Yellow Pages under "Copying and Duplicating Services."

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds 2003

Action Words for Resume Writers

Directions: *Circle the words below that describe what you have done in jobs, school, sports, community groups, etc. you have had. You may want to use some of these ACTION words on your resume. Ask and instructor or look up words you are not sure of.*

achieved
acquainted
activated
adapted
adjusted
administered
advertised
advised
advocated
aided
altered
analyzed
approved
arranged
assembled
assisted
assumed
attached
attained
authorized

balanced
built

calculated
catered
classified
coached
collected
combined
communicated
compared
completed
computed
condensed
constructed
consulted
controlled
converted
coordinated
counseled
created

decorated
delivered
demonstrated
designated
designed
detected
determined
developed
devised
diagnosed
directed
disclosed
discontinued
dispatched
displayed
distributed
documented

economized
edited
educated
eliminated
employed
encouraged
endorsed
engineered
established
estimated
evaluated
examined
exchanged
executed
expanded
experimented

familiarized
filmed
formulated

generated
governed
guaranteed
guarded
guided

hosted

illustrated
improved
increased
informed
initiated
inspected
instructed
interviewed
interpreted
introduced
invented
inventoried
investigated

lectured
located

maintained
managed
measured
merged
minimized
mixed
modernized
modified
motivated

notified

observed
obtained
operated
organized
originated

planned
prescribed
processed
procured
produced
provided
publicized
published

recommended
recorded
reduced
refinished
regulated
remodeled
removed
renovated
reorganized
repaired
replaced
reported
researched
restored

scheduled
screened
selected
simplified
solved
stabilized
stocked
strengthened
suggested
supervised
surpassed

tailored
taught
tested
trained
transferred
transformed
transported
treated

unified
updated
utilized

Note to Youth Workers: Be sure to discuss with youth the meaning of any words they may not be familiar with or know. Help connect these new words to the skills and experiences of the young person.

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

Resume Worksheet

Contact Information

Name

Address

City State Zip

Phone Number Alternate Phone Number E-mail

Employment Goal

What is your objective or job target?

What industry do you want to work in? (Construction, finance, maintenance and repair, hotel/hospitality, human services, healthcare, education, etc)

Skills

List all your skills (if you speak another language that is also a skill) and your strengths. For computer skills include software that you know. (Example: Microsoft Word, Excel, Internet Applications, etc)

Job Readiness Level

Education Information

Name of your school

Town/location of your school

Year you will be graduating

Awards

List all awards that you have ever received. If you were involved in sports also list any medals you may have won. (E.g.: perfect attendance, gold in 100 m hurdles)

Certificates

List any certifications you have ever received. (E.g.: CPR, First Aid, Workplace Readiness, etc.)

List any student activities or internships here:

Work History and Volunteer Experience

List your work history and/or volunteer history starting with your most recent job/volunteer work.

Start End Name of company

City and State

Your Title/Position

Describe what you did on the job (action words)

Start End Name of company

City and State

Your Title/Position

Describe what you did on the job (action words)

Start End Name of company

City and State

Your Title/Position

Describe what you did on the job (action words)

Adapted from Youth Opportunities Unlimited, Boston, MA

Sample Resume

Domenique Cortez
154 Brigham Street, Apt. 3
Billings, MA 02239
(617) 949-6672
dcortez@aol.com

EDUCATION:

Westover Job Corps, Graduated February 2000
Chicopee, MA

- Earned GED Certificate
- Successfully completed training in Accounting

Merimac High School, 1995 – 1998
Billings, MA

You should include high school (even if you did not earn your diploma from your high school), Job Corps (even if you did not complete your program), and any other school you attended.

SKILLS:

Computer: Microsoft Word, Microsoft Excel, internet

Other: Fluent in Spanish

In today's job market, computer Skills and the ability to speak languages other than English Are two of the most valuable types of skills. Take some time to think about other skills you have that might be useful in a job setting (for example, customer service skills).

EXPERIENCE:

Waitress **March 1998 – April 1999**
Friendly's Restaurant **Merrimac, MA**

- Waited on tables during busy evening hours at family restaurant
- Assisted in training new wait staff
- Acted as hostess when needed
- Earned "Waitress of the Month" award (December 1998)

Cashier **July 1997 – February 1998**
Town Variety Store **Merrimac, MA**

- Provided customer service in a convenience store
- Assisted in scheduling employees
- Monitored store inventory

Think about ALL the job-related experiences you have had. This might include jobs you've held, informal jobs (such as baby-sitting), and/or volunteer work. Don't lie or brag on your resume, but DO mention your accomplishments and promotions.

OTHER ACTIVITIES:

Job Corps: Student Government Association President, WICS Council Member, Tutored elementary school children while attending Job Corps

Other: Merrimac track team (1995 – 1996)

This section is important for job seekers who have not held many jobs. It shows that, while you have not had a lot of JOB experience, you have had some experiences that gave you a chance to develop skills that will be useful in the job market.

REFERENCES AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST.

Be ready to provide the names of two or three people who would recommend you for a job.

Adapted from Youth Opportunity Unlimited, Boston, MA

John Doe

123 MAIN STREET, WORCESTER, MA
614-555-1212 • johndoe@yahoo.com

Skills

- Excellent customer service, interpersonal and communication skills
- Flexible team player with the ability to complete tasks independently
- Bilingual: Spanish and English
- Computer proficiency: Internet search, Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint

Education

High School Diploma, North High School, expected June 2012

Experience

Worcester Teen Center — Worcester, MA

Team Member, Summer 2010

- Performed general facilities maintenance work, including painting and cleaning
- Worked on a team to organize a community backpack drive for local students
- Completed professional development training

Worcester County Food Bank — Worcester, MA

Volunteer, March 2010-present

- Aided in the collection, organization and distribution of food baskets to families in need
- Worked with a diverse staff to complete projects in a timely manner
- Maintained a clean and safe working environment

Extracurricular Activities

• Basketball Team	North High School	Spring 2009/2010
• Writing/Drawing	Teen Center's monthly newsletter	March 2010-present

Michael White

123 Washington St, Springfield MA
413-987-6543
michael_white@gmail.com

SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

- Motivated, responsible, hard worker
- Excellent communication and organizational skills
- Initiative-taker and problem-solver
- Team player with strong customer service skills

EDUCATION

Earned GED, Smith Community Center — May 2010
Springfield Central High School — 2007-2009

TRAINING

Massachusetts Career Development Institute — Nov. 2009-May 2010

Culinary Arts Program

- Learned the basics of food preparation and kitchen management
- Followed directions and worked on a team to prepare and serve food
- Adapted to different job assignments and completed all tasks

EXPERIENCE

St Patrick's Soup Kitchen — June 2010-present

Kitchen Crew Volunteer

- Help to prepare meals for people in need
- Maintain a clean working environment: wash dishes and mop as needed
- Serve meals and provide excellent customer service

CERTIFICATION

Earned ServSafe Certificate — Jan. 2010
Earned OSHA Certificate — April 2010

Sample Resume

2833 W. 24th Street• Deland, FL 32720
Phone: 386-555-3080 • E-Mail Suzie.Student@yahoo.com

SUZIE STUDENT

OBJECTIVE

- Seeking part-time retail sales clerk/cashier position

SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

- Customer-focused self-starter with proven client services skills
- Energetic achiever and communicator, with strong listening skills
- Quick learner, eager to gain knowledge and follow directions
- Excellent team player who thrives in teamwork situations
- Responsible and reliable, with record of professionalism

EDUCATION

- **High School Diploma, *DeLand High School,*** DeLand, FL, expected May 2007

HONORS AND DISTINCTIONS

- Achieved Honor Roll, DeLand High, 2005-2006
- Earned Certificate of Achievement for Outstanding Performance in Math on FCAT, 2005
- Earned Varsity Letter, DeLand High Soccer Team, 2004-2006

WORK HISTORY

Bagger, *Publix Super Markets,* DeLand, FL, Summer 2006

- Prepared bagged groceries to customer specifications
- Assisted in loading groceries to customer vehicles
- Secured shopping carts and other key supplies
- Provided customer service to average of 60 customers per shift

Baby-sitter, *Suzie's baby-sitting Services,* DeLand, FL, 2001 to present

- Maintain satisfied clientele of 10 families
- Provide quality care for children aged newborn to 12 years
- Manage all aspects of business

COMMUNITY SERVICE

- Supplied 80 hours at Woodland Towers retirement community, Jan. to Feb. 2006
- Donated more than 200 hours to DeLand Museum of Art, Fall 2005 and Spring, 2006
- Contributed more than 150 volunteer hours to DeLand Museum Art Summer Camp, Summer 2005

SKILLS

- Customer relations, customer service
- Computer literate in both Windows and Macintosh platforms
- Working knowledge of Spanish and Italian

Adapted from http://www.quintcareers.com/SuzieStudent-Teen-Resume.pdf Retrieved April 29, 2010

Evaluating your Resume

After your resume is completed, use this form to evaluate it.

APPEARANCE AND FORMAT

_____ 1. The overall appearance is neat and business-like.

_____ 2. The typing is sharp and clean.

_____ 3. The paper is high quality.

_____ 4. The paper is spotless and free of wrinkles.

_____ 5. The use of "white space" enhances the resume.

_____ 6. A consistent format is used.

CONTENT

_____ 7. The resume emphasizes results, achievements, and problem solving skills.

_____ 8. The most qualifying experiences are emphasized.

_____ 9. Information on education is complete.

_____ 10. Honors and awards reflect ability.

_____ 11. Controversial activities or associations are avoided.

_____ 12. Reasons for leaving employment are not given.

_____ 13. Information is factual.

_____ 14. The strongest experiences and skills are described first.

_____ 15. The content supports the job objective.

_____ 16. There are no obvious gaps in your employment history.

WRITING STYLE

_____ 17. Short phrases are used.

_____ 18. Action words are used.

_____ 19. "I" is not used.

_____ 20. Present tense is used for current activities.

_____ 21. Past tense is used for previous experiences.

_____ 22. Information given is brief and necessary.